

Early-Vote Analysis — Tester Guide

Live app: <https://earlyvote-analysis.vercel.app>

What this application does

It reads the **partisan early-voting signal** in U.S. swing states — county by county — during the weeks before an election, and shows whether the early electorate is tilting more Democratic or more Republican than in comparable past cycles (2020, 2022, 2024).

Because the ballot is secret, the app never sees *who* someone voted for during early voting. Instead it measures the **composition** of the early electorate: it weights each county's early-vote volume by that county's historical partisan lean, so you can read whether the people voting early are coming disproportionately from Democratic-leaning or Republican-leaning places. It answers three questions at a glance:

1. **Partisan shift** — is each county a bigger or smaller slice of the early vote than in 2020 / 2022 / 2024?
2. **Aggregate Dem tilt** — combining all counties, is the early electorate more Democratic-tilted than past cycles?
3. **Turnout progress** — how far along is early voting, both as a % of each county's prior full turnout and as a true % of registered voters.

Purpose

Gives campaigns, analysts, and journalists an **early, actionable read** on turnout so they can act *before* election day — e.g. spot a Democratic stronghold that is under-performing its baseline and redirect get-out-the-vote effort to where it moves the needle.

States covered (v1)

State	Party registration?	Early-vote breakdown in baseline
North Carolina	Yes	full (in-person early + mail)
Georgia	No (county-lean)	full
Arizona	Yes	full (incl. late-early)

Nevada	Yes	totals-only
Pennsylvania	Yes	totals-only (mail-heavy)

Important caveat

Until real early voting opens (~October 2026), the current-cycle numbers are **synthetic stand-ins** generated from the historical baseline. The analytical engine, historical baselines, and live-ingestor parsers are all real and tested; only the current-cycle values are placeholders until state feeds go live.

How to read the dashboard

Switch states with the **tabs** at the top. The page answers one question — *is the early electorate tilting more Democratic or more Republican than in past cycles, and how far along is turnout* — for five swing states (GA, NC, AZ, NV, PA).

1. Summary cards

- **Early ballots so far** — total early ballots in the current feed, and that total as a % of each year's full early vote (a rough "how far along" gauge).
- **Net turnout edge vs 2022 and vs 2020** — the headline. Combines the Dem-leaning and Rep-leaning county groups into one number: Dem-group share change minus Rep-group share change, in points. Blue/positive = toward Democratic turnout; red/negative = toward Republican.

2. Aggregate Dem tilt of the early electorate

Four bars — 2020, 2022, 2024, and the current cycle — showing the composite Democratic tilt: each county's fixed partisan lean weighted by its share of that year's early vote. The tick mark is 50%. Differences between bars come only from where the early votes concentrate.

3. Turnout progress vs full prior turnout

A headline stat — approximately what % of registered voters have voted early (marked "est." while registration denominators are estimated). Three bars show the current early vote as a % of each year's total turnout; a bar past the 100% tick means early voting alone has already exceeded that entire past election.

4. County table (with a view toggle)

A sortable, filterable grid of every county. Click a column header to sort; type to filter by name; use the dropdown to show only Dem- or Rep-leaning counties. The toggle switches the right-hand columns between two views:

- **Partisan shift** — how much bigger (green) or smaller (red) a slice of the early vote that county is now, vs 2020/2022/2024.
- **Turnout progress** — current-cycle early votes as a % of that county's full turnout in each prior year.

How to interpret it correctly

The cells are party-neutral; the partisan meaning comes from pairing color with the county's lean.

A green cell only means "this county is a bigger slice of the early vote than that year." Read the party signal by combining it with the **Grp** badge:

Cell	County Grp	Meaning
Green	D (Dem-leaning)	good for Democrats (a Dem area over-voting)
Green	R (Rep-leaning)	good for Republicans (a Rep area over-voting)
Red	D	bad for Democrats
Red	R	bad for Republicans

So the Democratic edge = Dem-leaning counties green + Rep-leaning counties red, together — exactly what the "Net turnout edge" card summarizes.

Cells in one row can be mixed. A county can be ahead of its 2022 pace but behind 2020 and 2024 — that's expected.

Which year to trust most. The current cycle is a midterm, so **2022** (also a midterm) is the apples-to-apples comparator. 2020 and 2024 are presidential — read those as directional context, not literal pace.

Nuances & caveats

- **It's composition, not vote choice.** Everything measures *where* early voters come from, not *who* they voted for.
- **Share is zero-sum.** If Dem-leaning counties gain share, Rep-leaning counties mechanically lose it — the two groups look like mirror images. The **net** line is the clean signal.
- **A few big counties dominate** in AZ (Maricopa) and NV (Clark) — judge by share, not county count.
- **NV & PA are totals-only** in the source data, so their signal runs on total-vote share rather than early-vote share.

- **Turnout rate is an estimate** until real Secretary-of-State registration files replace the current denominator.